Travel and Expense Policy

Brightpath Technologies Pvt. Ltd. | Document ID: BP-FIN-004 | Version 2.3

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1. Purpose

This policy sets out how business travel is booked and which expenses are reimbursed, so that employees travel safely and costs are controlled.

2. Booking travel

- All flights, trains and hotels must be booked through the company travel desk at travel@brightpath.example.
- Domestic travel must be requested at least 7 days in advance and international travel at least 21 days in advance.
- Bookings made within the advance window require additional approval from the department head.
- International travel always requires approval from the department head and Finance.

3. Mode and class of travel

Grade	Air travel	Rail travel
L1 to L3	Economy class, only when the one-way distance is more than 500 km	AC 3-tier, or AC 2-tier for overnight journeys
L4 to L6	Economy class	AC 2-tier
L7 and above	Economy class for flights under 4 hours; business class for flights of 4 hours or more	AC First Class

4. Hotel accommodation limits (per night, excluding taxes)

Grade	Tier 1 cities (Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad, Pune)	Tier 2 and other cities
L1 to L3	INR 4,500	INR 3,000
L4 to L6	INR 7,000	INR 5,000
L7 and above	INR 10,000	INR 7,500

Employees who stay with friends or family instead of a hotel may claim a fixed allowance of INR 1,000 per night.

5. Daily allowance (per diem)

The daily allowance covers meals and incidental expenses and does not need receipts. For domestic travel, the allowance is INR 1,200 per day for grades L1 to L3 and INR 1,800 per day for grade L4 and above. For international travel, the allowance is USD 60 per day for all grades. Travel of less than 8 hours on a day qualifies for half the daily allowance.

6. Local conveyance

- Taxis and app-based cabs are reimbursed at actuals for business travel.
- Use of a personal car is reimbursed at INR 12 per km, and a personal two-wheeler at INR 5 per km.
- Daily commute between home and the employee's base office is not reimbursable.

7. Client entertainment

Client meals and entertainment require prior approval from the department head and are capped at INR 2,500 per head. Names of attendees and the business purpose must be recorded in the claim.

8. Travel advance

Employees may request a travel advance of up to 75% of the estimated trip cost. The advance must be settled by submitting the expense claim within 15 days of returning. Unsettled advances are recovered from salary.

9. Submitting claims

- Expense claims must be submitted in the PeopleHub Expenses module within 30 days of the end of the trip. Claims submitted later are not reimbursed unless approved by the CFO.
- Original receipts are required for every expense above INR 500.
- Claims are approved by the reporting manager and then verified by Finance.
- Approved claims are reimbursed with the next payroll cycle, or within 10 working days, whichever is earlier.

10. Non-reimbursable expenses

- Alcohol, tobacco and hotel minibar charges
- Traffic fines, parking fines and penalties
- Personal entertainment, spa, laundry for trips shorter than 4 nights
- Travel insurance purchased separately (international travel is covered by the company policy)
- Upgrades to a higher class of travel or hotel than the employee's entitlement